Manipal Hackathon 2026

Who gets to tell a culture's story?

Cultural tourism prioritizes visitors, while custodians lack control over their stories, access, and value.

TEAM NAME: Team Appex

TRACK: Culture and Community

PROBLEM STATEMENT: Custodian: Culture on Its Own Terms

SOLUTION: A custodian-first digital platform for discovering, experiencing and preserving living culture.

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01

Solution

Culture, on its own terms.

A custodian-first platform that makes consent, language and fair value part of every cultural encounter.

Native-language storytelling

Original voice, not a diluted summary.

AI-assisted multilingual access

Translation without replacing authority.

Custodian-controlled consent

Set what can be seen, shared or booked.

Direct participation & monetization

Value returns to knowledge holders.



THE IMBALANCE

When culture travels without its custodians, meaning and value travel away.

01 Stories get simplified for audiences who do not live them.

02 Language and context are treated as friction-not heritage.

03 Local knowledge creates demand, but rarely captures its value.

Custodian → Defines → Traveller discovers → Participates → Value returns

TECHNICAL IMPLEMENTATION

Built for provenance, not performance.

Every answer is grounded in custodial content, permissions and context.

> *"AI translates culture. It does not invent it."*

Consent is a first-class data layer: scope, audience, reuse rights and revenue rules travel alongside each story.

audio · text · photos · boundaries

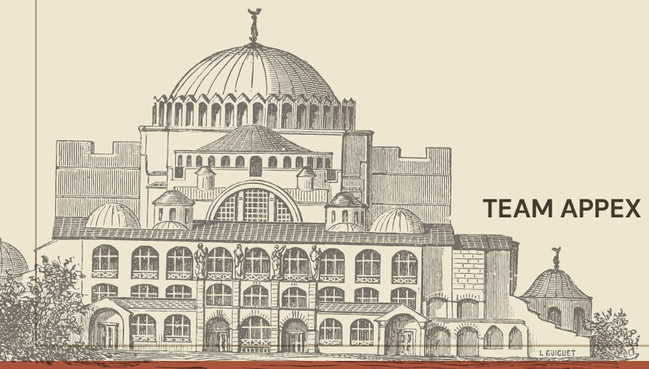
Custodian content → permissions · attribution · rules **Consent layer** → structured, provenance-aware records **Cultural knowledge store**

retrieval-grounded translation

AI / RAG → map · story · boundaries **Traveller interface** → experience · craft · contribution **Booking / support**

FASTAPI / NODE REACT / NEXT.JS POSTGRESQL PGVECTOR SPEECH-TO-TEXT LLM / RAG

01	**Choose language**	access without erasure
02	**Explore map**	place-led discovery
03	**Discover custodian**	the source is visible
04	**Hear original story**	voice + translation
05	**Respect boundaries**	consent travels with context
06	**Participate / support**	book, buy, contribute



TEAM APPEX

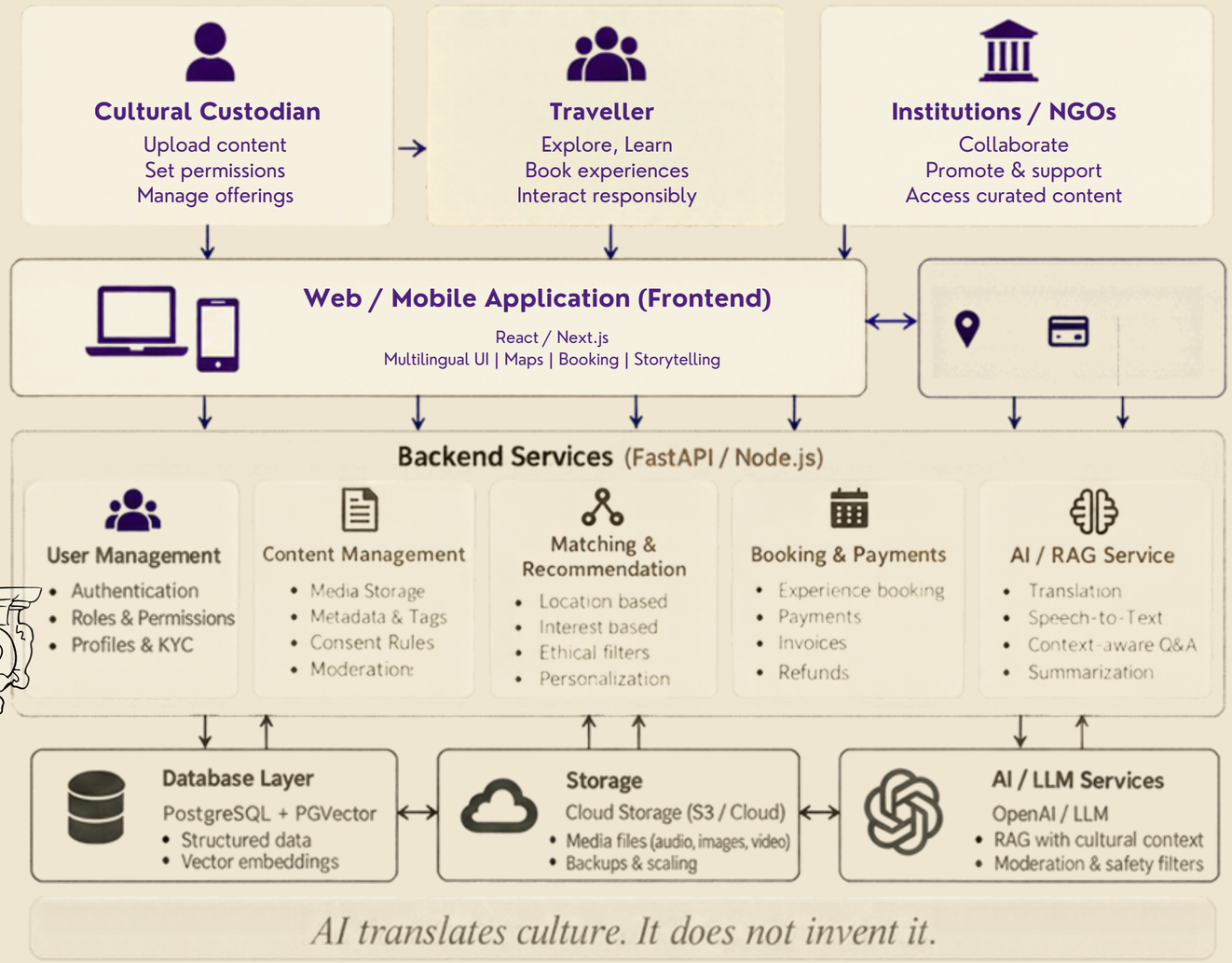
The map does not extract a story. It introduces a relationship.

TECHNOLOGY & STRATEGY

BUILT WITH PURPOSE, BACKED BY TECHNOLOGY, GROUNDED IN REALITY.

SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

A secure, scalable and custodian-first platform architecture



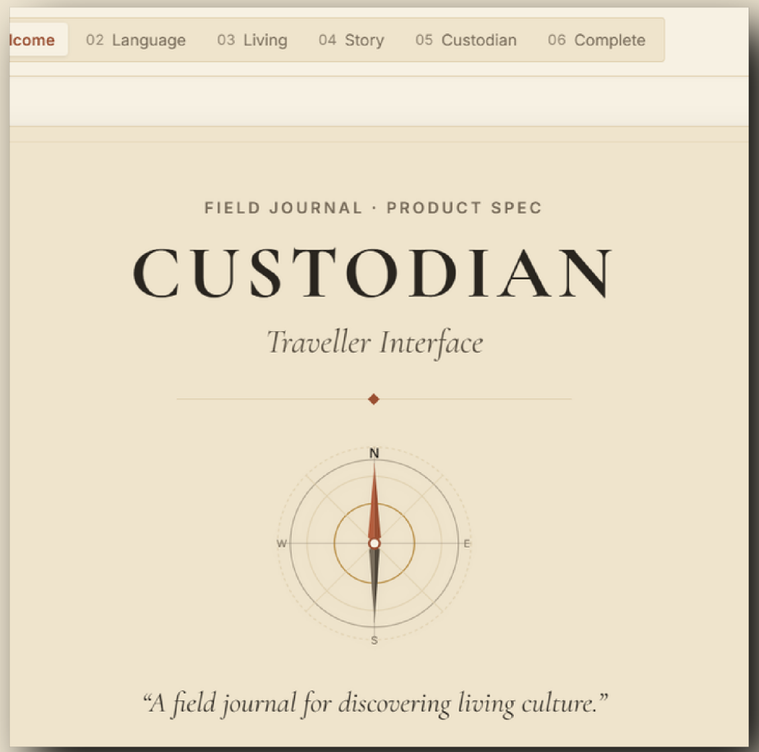
AI translates culture. It does not invent it.

Business model

Category	Details
Value Proposition	Authentic cultural experiences, Income & visibility for custodians, Support for NGOs & institutions
Revenue	Booking commission, Custodian subscriptions, Institutional partnerships, Grants & CSR
Cost	Platform & AI, Cloud infrastructure, Content verification, Marketing & operations
Flow	Custodian → Platform → Traveller → Revenue → Community Impact

FEASIBILITY & IMPACT

PROTOTYPE DEMONSTRATION



Target Audience :

- Custodians
- Travellers
- Cultural Institutions
- Business Model: Experience & craft commissions
- Institutional partnerships • CSR/Grants

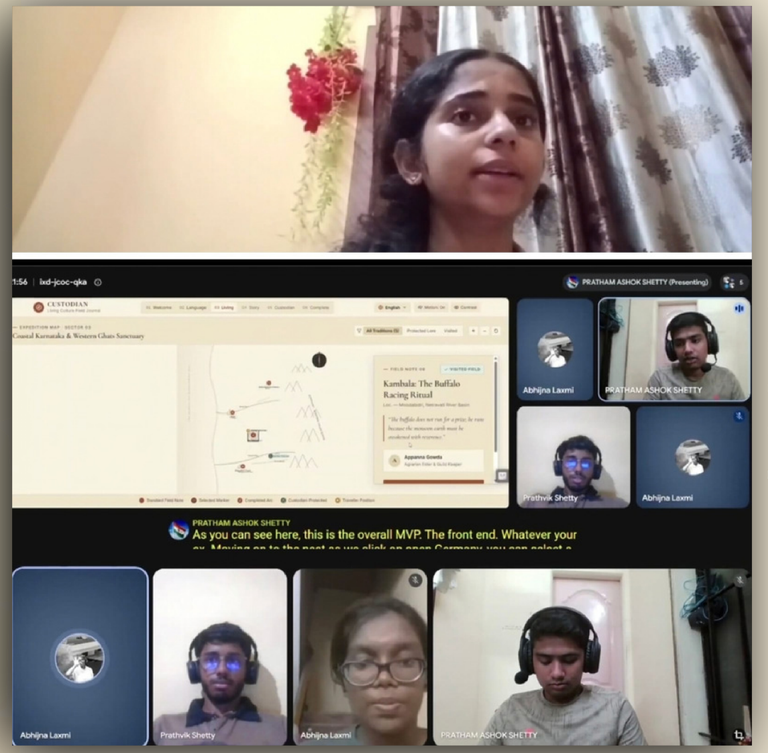
Impact :

- Preserve culture
- Empower custodians
- Promote regional languages

References :

- UNESCO ICH
- UN SDG 11
- Ministry of Culture
- Ministry of Tourism

DEMO VIDEO



GITHUB

https://github.com/prathvikshettyy/custodian

Culture isn't content.
It is community-owned knowledge.